

MB 403: French

Course Code: MB 403

Course Name: French

L-T-P-C: 3-0-0-3

Prerequisites: NA

Intended for: Integrated MBA

Mutual Exclusion: HS 591

Approval: 59th BoA (I-MBA curriculum); course proposal given one-time approval in the 65th BoA

Preamble

This course introduces complete beginners (CEFR A0) to French for business and everyday communication, bringing them to a solid elementary level (CEFR A1) by the end of the semester. It strengthens the four core competences: listening, speaking, reading and writing, through practical situations such as professional introductions, company descriptions, meetings, everyday transactions and short written messages. Priority is given to oral practice, through role-plays, short presentations and practical cases, to build confidence in real professional and everyday exchanges, while introducing the social and cultural codes (forms of address, greetings) of a French-speaking context.

Course Modules

- **Unit 1: The Basics:** (12 hours)

- Introduction to French pronunciation and the alphabet; greetings and politeness formulas; the tu/vous distinction and basic social codes (handshake vs. bises); self-introductions (name, nationality, profession, contact details, spelling one's name).
- Numbers, prices, telling the time, days of the week and months, and expressions of time used for schedules and daily/work routines.
- Present tense of être, avoir and the pronominal verbs, of regular -er verbs, and of the most frequent irregular verbs; basic sentence structure; simple negation (ne...pas); asking questions (est-ce que, qu'est-ce que, où, quand, combien), near future and near past.
- Describing colleagues or classmates, family, company departments, and one's academic background (field of study, courses, campus life), useful vocabulary for a CV profile or an admission interview.

- **Unit 2: Listening and Comprehension Skills:** (10 hours)

- Understanding simple everyday and workplace instructions and directions (an office, a campus, a pharmacy, a bank).
- Identifying key information and main points from short audio-visual clips related to companies, studies abroad and everyday situations.
- Close listening exercises with everyday and professional dialogues (a business phone call, renting a room, opening a bank account, a doctor's or pharmacy visit, a restaurant order).
- Reading and comprehension activities with short everyday and business documents (a lease or housing ad, a bank form, a menu, an email, a class schedule).

- **Unit 3: Speaking Skills:** (10 hours)

- Identifying and practising intonation patterns in polite everyday and professional exchanges (requests, questions, confirmations).
- Ordering food and drinks at a café or restaurant, and asking for and giving simple directions using the imperative (tournez, continuez, prenez la rue...).
- Role-playing everyday and professional scenarios: exchanging business cards at a networking event, a short job or admission interview, renting accommodation, opening a bank account, a pharmacy visit, etc.
- Short presentations introducing oneself, one's studies or company, and stating simple upcoming plans (aller + infinitive).

• **Unit 4: Writing Skills:** (4 hours)

- Writing short sentences with core grammatical structures (question and answer, affirmation and negation, near future and near past) in everyday and professional contexts.
- Writing short everyday and professional messages: an introductory email, a housing or appointment request, and a simple form (registration, bank, CV profile).

Laboratory/Practical/Tutorial Modules

NA

Text Books

1. *Edito A1, methode de francais*, editions Didier, 2016.
2. *Travailler en entreprise*, Editions Didier, 2009.

References

1. *Cours de Langue et de Civilisation Francais* by G. Mauger.
2. *Dondo Modern French Course* by M Ferlin.
3. Jean Benoit, Nicholas Rollin, *The Oxford Hachette French Dictionary*, Oxford University Press, 2007.